



2 Receptive skills: listening for specific information

Receptive skills · IB Diploma · Concept guide and original exam-style practice

Understand the concept

Listening tasks in English B require picking out specific information, such as numbers, names, opinions and the sequence of events, while note-taking during the playing of an audio text. Success depends on using the reading time before playback to predict vocabulary and question focus, then writing key words rather than full sentences while listening, since answers are usually short.

Worked example: follow the reasoning

Question: 'What time does the museum tour start?' Predicted vocabulary during reading time: time expressions (o'clock, a.m./p.m., morning). While listening, the student notes only '10:30' rather than trying to transcribe the whole sentence heard in the audio.

Quick check · multiple choice

During the reading time given before an audio text is played, what is the most useful strategy?

- A Writing full predicted sentences for every answer
- B Reading the questions and predicting key vocabulary and question focus
- C Practising handwriting speed
- D Ignoring the questions until the audio starts

Write your choice: _____

Structured practice

Answer in the space provided.

- 1 Listening task: you will hear a short announcement about a change to a train timetable (imagine the audio). Based on the description below, write the four short answers a candidate should record. [20]

Description of audio content: an announcer explains that the 8:15 service to Lakeside has been cancelled due to maintenance work, replaced by an extra service at 8:45, and reminds passengers that tickets bought for the 8:15 service remain valid all day.

1. Which service is cancelled?
2. Why is it cancelled?
3. What replaces it, and at what time?
4. What can passengers do with their existing ticket?

Final answer: _____



Answers and explanation

Question 1 [20]

A strong answer records short, precise notes rather than full sentences:

- Q1: '8:15 to Lakeside'
- Q2: 'maintenance work' (exact cause, not a vague guess)
- Q3: 'extra service, 8:45'
- Q4: 'ticket valid all day', can use it on any train that day
- Answers use key words spelled correctly, match the exact information given with no invented detail, and are recorded in the order the information appears in the audio

Quick check answer

B. Predicting vocabulary and focus before listening helps the student recognise relevant information faster during playback.

Self-assessment

Compare each credited step with your own answer. Fix the first reasoning or content error, then retry the practice question without looking at the solution.

Based on the IB English B guide (2018).

Original FagusED teaching material. Not an official IB publication; the sample scenarios and language are invented and generic.